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UN Tourism

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Urban Solutions

CULTURE-DRIVEN SUSTAINABLE URBAN TOURISM



A UNESCO, UN TOURISM AND UN-HABITAT COLLABORATION

Cultural tourism, as defined by UN Tourism, is a “type of tourism activity in which the visitor's essential motivation is to learn, discover, experience and consume the tangible and intangible cultural attractions/products in a tourism destination”.[1] It is one of the fastest-growing segments of the tourism sector, representing around 40% of all tourism worldwide.[2] This type of tourism encompasses heritage sites, crafts, languages, performing arts, gastronomy, festivals, special events, and museums among others.

That is exactly why tourism policies and practices should prioritize the protection and preservation of both tangible and intangible cultural heritage for future generations and ensure they are accessible to tourists, fostering a deeper understanding of cultural diversity and heritage.

By leveraging their distinctive blend of tangible and intangible heritage alongside contemporary culture, countries and cities around the world are maximizing the power of cultural tourism as a driver of sustainable development. Cultural tourism contributes to job creation, regeneration of both urban and rural areas, and the safeguarding of natural and cultural heritage.[3]

Cities are at the forefront of cultural tourism, acting as dynamic hubs where diverse cultural, architectural, technological, social and natural experiences come together[4] to showcase a nation’s rich heritage and creativity of local communities. As cities continue to attract growing numbers of tourists, they are in a unique position to harness the potential of culture-driven sustainable urban tourism, not only to boost the local economy and attract impactful investments, but also to promote social cohesion and urban regeneration. Such growth, should be adequately managed, as it may bring with it significant challenges, putting considerable pressure on urban infrastructure and social pattern. Effective planning and management are essential to ensure that the influx of visitors enhances rather than undermines the safeguarding of cultural assets and expressions and the quality of life of local communities.

Within this context, local governments need to develop specific short and long-term policies and strategies for the sustainable development of cultural urban tourism. This requires allocating sufficient financial and human resources, as well as establishing strong governance through coordination within the public sector, collaboration between public and private sectors, and community engagement.

Under such a public-private-community governance approach, the interests and needs of both direct and indirect actors, must be adequately represented. However, the planning

[1] World Tourism Organization (2019), UNWTO Tourism Definitions, UNWTO, Madrid, DOI: https://doi.org/10.18111/9789284420858.
[2] Cutting Edge | Bringing cultural tourism back in the game (UNESCO, 2021)
[3] Ibid.
[4] Urban Tourism (UN Tourism, N/A)

and management of tourism policies often lack full participation from all stakeholders, notably local communities. Therefore, effective coordination requires cross-sectoral alignment (e.g., mobility, housing, infrastructure) and multi-level cooperation between national, regional, and local governments. Without which, urban tourism may face negative impacts, such as unregulated development in areas lacking urban plans, threats to cultural and natural assets, and the exclusion of local communities from tourism benefits.

While there is a growing interest in travelling in a more sustainable and responsible manner, with 71% of travellers intending to travel more sustainably, there remains a significant gap between tourism consumers' intentions and behaviour, largely due to a lack of awareness and knowledge.[5] This highlights the urgent need for urban solutions that integrate culture into tourism development, fostering sustainability through collaboration between local governments, cultural institutions, the private sector, local communities, and visitors.

In addition to these efforts, the United Nations (UN) General Assembly adopted a resolution on February 2024, declaring the "International Year of Sustainable and Resilient Tourism, 2027". This resolution recognizes that sustainable tourism, including ecotourism, is a cross-cutting activity that can significantly contribute to achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), particularly through the promotion of local culture.

The following **Urban Solutions**, developed by **UNESCO** in collaboration with **UN Tourism** and **UN-Habitat**, focus on integrating culture into sustainable urban tourism policies and strategies. By leveraging cultural heritage, creativity, and local traditions, these Solutions aim to foster economic development, social cohesion, cultural diversity and environmental sustainability in cities through tourism. By engaging local governments, communities, vulnerable groups, the private sector and visitors, they can encourage cultural understanding and sustainable growth, positioning tourism as a catalyst for positive change.

Culture-driven tourism can and must be a central component of urban policies to achieve the SDGs, in particular Goal 11 on "Make cities and human settlements inclusive, safe, resilient and sustainable", and the New Urban Agenda, notably paragraph 124 that highlights the commitment to "include culture as a priority component of urban plans and strategies". This vision aligns with several key initiatives, including the MONDIACULT 2022 Declaration, which recognizes culture as a "global public good"; the UNESCO Creative Cities Network Braga Manifesto, which highlights sustainable urban tourism as a

[5] The promise and challenges of sustainable travel products (World Economic Forum, 2022)

driver of socioeconomic progress; the UN Tourism Recommendations on Urban Tourism;[6] and the Global Code of Ethics, particularly Article 4, which focuses on tourism as both a user of cultural heritage and a contributor to its enhancement. In parallel, these solutions echo the UNESCO Cities Platform's Urban Solutions on "Adapting Cities for Climate Resilience" and support UN-Habitat's advocacy for local community engagement in the development process.

Collectively, these approaches ensure that culture-driven sustainable urban tourism contributes meaningfully to the broader goals of sustainable and inclusive urban development, particularly by integrating vulnerable groups, and indigenous peoples into the tourism development process. Strategically positioned on the nexus of the mandates of the three above-mentioned UN entities, these Urban Solutions are part of the ONE UN side event titled "Urban tourism: Policies and governance for more sustainable, inclusive, creative and resilient cities" organized during the 12th World Urban Forum (WUF), aimed at rallying for global efforts in support of the UN mandate and the SDGs. It also builds on insights from the Expert Group Meeting on "Advancing Sustainable Urban Tourism: developing tools for promoting good practices in cities" held in Bilbao, Spain in March 2024, where experts from various UN agencies, international organizations, representatives of national, regional and local governments, academia and the private sector, discussed how to create better policies and governance models that ensure urban tourism benefits all.[7]

[6] World Tourism Organization (2020), UNWTO Recommendations on Urban Tourism, UNWTO, Madrid, DOI: https://doi.org/10.18111/9789284422012
[7] UN Tourism and UN Habitat Partner for a Better Urban Future Through Tourism (UN Tourism, 2024)

Solution 1: Cultural Heritage Preservation and Promotion

For Local Governments

Develop and implement policies and frameworks that focus on safeguarding, conserving, and promoting both tangible and intangible cultural heritage in a sustainable manner, taking into account the balance between development and cultural heritage safeguarding.

For Local Communities

Engage in conservation initiatives and in collaborative platforms that promote and safeguard local heritage; take pride in cultural heritage, develop a sense of responsibility towards its protection, and contribute to the sustainable management of tourism in cultural heritage destinations.[8]

For Visitors

Participate in sustainable tourism activities led by local experts and professionals to gain a deeper understanding of cultural heritage and support local traditional artisans; understand and appreciate the meaning of outstanding universal value of cultural heritage and adopt responsible behaviour.[9]

Why?

Supporting cultural heritage is crucial to maintaining the unique identity of cities, fostering civic pride, and attracting sustainable tourism managed and practiced in a responsible manner. When the number of visitors to heritage sites exceeds their carrying capacity, it can undermine conservation efforts and compromise both the integrity and authenticity of heritage sites, the visitors' experience and the wellbeing of local communities. While culture in all its forms evolves, over-commercialization of intangible heritage practices – including taking these practices out of context – for tourism purposes, can risk inadvertently changing the practice over time,[10] thus resulting in negative outcomes. Heritage conservation ensures the continuity of cultural practices and local sites, enriching the urban experience for both residents and tourists. By safeguarding and promoting cultural heritage, cities can create vibrant, inclusive, and sustainable urban environments that honour the past while embracing the future.

[8] UNESCO World Heritage and Sustainable Tourism Programme (UNESCO)
[9] Ibid.
[10] Cutting Edge | Bringing cultural tourism back in the game (UNESCO, 2021)

Solution 2: Community-Centred Tourism Development

For Local Governments

Develop and implement policies and frameworks for sustainable urban tourism that incorporate cultural aspects involving the community, vulnerable groups and the private sector; encourage and provide opportunities for local communities to actively participate in decision-making processes that may impact their traditions, their quality of life and the local economy; empower local communities and provide training and resources to help them develop tourism skills and manage their own tourism initiatives; improve performance by measuring the impact of policies and strategies.

For Local Communities

Create and promote unique tourism experiences that highlight local culture and traditions, such as cultural festivals and eco-friendly tourism or gastronomy activities, and encourage local entrepreneurship by supporting small and medium-sized businesses and ensure greater participation in the tourism value chain. Take ownership of community-based tourism initiatives that reflect local pride and offer unique cultural experiences.

For Visitors

Choose community-based tourism experiences that offer authentic interactions with local people and culture and that respect and preserve the local dynamics.

Why?

Community-based tourism refers to tourism activities that are managed and operated by local communities, offering visitors an immersive experience in their culture and traditions. It supports economic and social empowerment while preserving cultural and natural heritage. Beyond supporting local communities, it ensures that economic benefits stay local and creates more authentic experiences for visitors. This approach ensures shared prosperity from tourism, social inclusion and mitigates possible externalities of tourism through policies that set capacity limits and raise awareness. In addition, it helps to preserve and promote local culture and traditions, strengthening community ties and fostering a sense of ownership and pride in heritage. Stakeholders at different levels, including local communities and vulnerable groups, should be involved in tourism planning and management, ensuring that everyone is fully benefitting from the opportunities of cultural tourism. Policymakers need to ensure that the development of cultural tourism is pursued in the wider context of city and regional strategies, in close cooperation with local communities and industry.[11] In addition, cooperation with neighbouring regions and their communities can further enhance the effectiveness of such strategies and initiatives.

[11] Ibid.

Solution 3: Creative Urban Spaces and Regeneration

For Local Governments

Develop cultural spaces to serve as hubs for creative activities and integrate public art into urban planning and regeneration; preserve and regenerate the urban landscape by improving and innovating urban spaces, providing both local communities and tourists with enhanced opportunities resulting from creative and sustainable urban space management; encourage partnerships with the private sector and local stakeholders to support these initiatives and ensure their long-term viability.

For Local Communities

Actively engage in nurturing creative urban spaces and regeneration by initiating or participating in the creation and maintenance of public art projects and cultural initiatives, as well as by getting involved in community-driven cultural events and workshops to support local professionals; engage in capacity-building programmes that empower residents to participate in sustainable tourism initiatives, ensuring that their voices are central to the preservation and development of their cultural heritage.

For Visitors

Discover and explore creative urban spaces, support local professionals by participating in workshops, guided tours, and place-based cultural and creative activities that actively engage the local community; actively contribute to the sustainability of the destinations they explore while respecting local customs and ecosystems.

Why?

Creative urban spaces and regeneration, enhance cultural vibrancy, attract tourism, and promote community engagement. When planned accordingly, they can support the expansion of tourism development to new urban areas promoting a better dispersal of tourism demand, while also paving the way for the creation of socially and environmentally conscious urban spaces that prioritize a better quality of life for residents and the environment. These spaces provide shared opportunities for both residents and visitors, enriching cultural life and providing platforms for cultural exchange and mutual understanding. By establishing creative urban spaces and initiating regeneration projects, cities can nurture dynamic environments that celebrate local heritage and creativity. This approach not only dynamizes urban areas, but also stimulates economic development by attracting tourists and fostering creativity, thereby making cities more inclusive, vibrant and liveable.

Solution 4: Sustainable Cultural Economy

For Local Governments

Provide policy incentives to create enabling and supportive environments for sustainable Cultural and Creative Industries (CCIs)[12] and cultural tourism projects led by the private sector; strike a balance between public and private investment; promote tourism related local products and services with geographical indication (GI) labels and encourage a dynamic management of local cultural offers to make urban tourism more sustainable in terms of destination and seasonal fluctuations; promote the integration of cultural and creative industries in the tourism value chain; to create synergies between various creative fields and tourism, such as gastronomy tourism, to link tourism, culture and economic development.

For Local Communities

Develop and manage community-based cultural enterprises, including focusing on empowering vulnerable groups, and promote local products and services; create employment opportunities within the economic ecosystem driven by sustainable tourism; collaborate with the private sector to foster the quality of innovation and growth in the local cultural economy.

For Visitors

Support sustainable and fair-trade cultural offerings by favouring local professionals and businesses, established, guided, and regulated by local authorities and/or professional and industrial associations.

Why?

A sustainable cultural economy ensures the long-term viability of cultural practices, provides economic benefits to local communities, notably vulnerable groups, and offers visitors unique and authentic experiences. By investing in and supporting CCIs, local governments can create stable and fairly paid jobs and contribute to the sustainable development of the tourism sector. The establishment of comprehensive local strategies allows cities to prioritize cultural projects and tourism marketing by encouraging cooperation between the public and private sectors and local communities. In addition to adding economic value, GI for cultural offers can also reduce the risk of heritage exploitation associated with, for example, crafts, textiles and food products, and promote its sustainable development.[13]

[12] UNESCO defines cultural and creative industries as activities whose principal purpose is production or reproduction, promotion, distribution or commercialization of goods, services and activities of a cultural, artistic or heritage-related nature. See for more information: Cultural times: the first global map of cultural and creative industries (UNESCO, 2015)
[13] Cutting Edge | Bringing cultural tourism back in the game (UNESCO, 2021)

Solution 5: Environmental and Cultural Synergy

For Local Governments

Implement policies that integrate environmental sustainability with urban tourism planning and management, ensuring that tourism development respects both natural and cultural resources; measure and monitor the socio-cultural and environmental impacts of tourism for policy-making based on data; encourage the development of environment-sensitive CCI for sustainable tourism; and stimulate environmentally friendly projects by private companies and groups through awards or certification labels, while avoiding greenwashing.

For Local Communities

Develop initiatives that promote and contribute to both environmental and cultural conservation, such as community-led eco-friendly tourism projects and heritage conservation programmes; collaborate with private companies to ensure the sustainability and lasting impact of these projects.

For Visitors

Choose sustainable travel options and support conservation efforts at natural and cultural heritage sites in cities by engaging in participative tourism activities; be aware of their carbon footprint, energy consumption and the use of renewable resources.

Why?

Integrating environmental sustainability into tourism, safeguards natural and cultural resources, builds community resilience, and attracts environmentally conscious tourists. This approach ensures the preservation of the natural resources and cultural heritage for future generations. The synergy between environmental and cultural sustainability creates a holistic tourism model that benefits all stakeholders and promotes a sustainable future for cities around the world.

Solution 6: Cultural Education and Exchange

For Local Governments

Develop educational programmes and establish cultural centres, museums, and visitor/community centres for learning and exchange, that serve local communities, professionals, and tourists; develop relationships with other local governments and participate in inter-city networks to exchange experiences and knowledge and fostering urban solutions to emerging challenges.

For Local Communities

Organize workshops and exchange activities, using museums and visitor/community centres as hubs for sharing and dynamizing local cultural heritage and practices, integrated into tourism offers.

For Visitors

Take part in cultural learning experiences offered by museums, visitor centres, and local communities, and participate in exchange programmes to gain a better understanding of the local communities and their culture.

Why?

Cultural education and inter-cultural exchanges promote mutual understanding, preserve cultural heritage, and enhance the visitor experience. Museums and cultural centres play a vital role by providing spaces where local history, traditions, and contemporary culture are showcased, experienced and transmitted. Training professionals, promoting regular exchanges between the public and private sectors and local communities, and learning from the examples of other cities can improve urban planning and sustainable tourism development strategies. In general, cultural education and training are crucial for both local communities and tourists, fostering a sense of respect and appreciation for cultural diversity in the local settings. This approach helps to create a more inclusive, informed, and cohesive community, ultimately leading to more sustainable and enriching tourism experiences.

Solution 7: Digital Cultural Innovation

For Local Governments

Establish inducive policies and invest in digital infrastructure with a view to developing online platforms for cultural promotion and experiences, ensuring that innovative cultural content is accessible to all, especially vulnerable groups, thus enhancing inclusivity; utilize technology to enhance visitor management at cultural attractions, ensuring a more enjoyable experience for both visitors and local communities.

For Local Communities

Build digital literacy and create virtual cultural assets and spaces; enable community members with adequate digital skills geared towards the promotion of local heritage and creativity; devise innovative cultural tourism experiences.

For Visitors

Explore virtual tours and engage with local culture through technology enabled platforms, using new innovative technologies to improve their experience, opening new avenues for interaction and participation.

Why?

Digital innovation improves and diversifies access to cultural resources, supports community engagement, and provides new avenues for tourism actors, including destinations, businesses, and cultural institutions. It also enhances inclusivity by improving accessibility for vulnerable groups, ensuring their participation in cultural and tourism activities within cities. Embracing digital transformation, harnessing technology, and using social media effectively and responsibly, are key to modernizing tourism and improving the visitor experience. In addition, social media has become a primary communication tool; using it effectively to attract visitors and raise their awareness is key to sustainable tourism. Local governments and communities, including the private sector, can leverage big data and algorithms to refine tourism strategies, optimize marketing efforts, and improve the visitor experiences. In parallel, new technologies such as virtual reality and augmented reality, and more recently artificial intelligence, offer innovative ways to enrich tourism offerings, providing immersive and interactive experiences that can attract a wider audience. These technologies not only enhance the visitor experience, but also contribute to accessibility and sustainability by reducing the need for physical travel and minimizing the environmental impact.

GOOD PRACTICES

Solution 1: Cultural Heritage Preservation and Promotion

Cebu, Philippines: *Cebu City Heritage District initiative*

The Cebu City Heritage District Council, established in early 2023, is responsible for the sustainable preservation, development, and management of the heritage district. The initiative focuses on preserving cultural heritage through eco-friendly practices, promoting Cebu's history to tourists, and involving local residents in conservation efforts. It aims to foster pride in cultural identity, encourage sustainable practices, promote economic development through heritage tourism, and enhance educational opportunities on Cebu's history, traditions, and architecture for students, scholars, and the public.

Dubrovnik, Croatia: *The Lazareti*

Creative Hub of Dubrovnik initiative revitalized the historical Lazareti complex, a former quarantine station near Dubrovnik's walls, transforming it into a vibrant cultural and tourism hub. Recognized as a cultural asset of Croatia, the project involved extensive renovations, equipping the complex with modern facilities, and creating diverse programs to ensure both institutional and financial sustainability. Led by the City of Dubrovnik in collaboration with ten public, private, and civil sector partners, the initiative established year-round cultural, scientific, educational, and tourism programs. The project emphasizes the touristic valorization of cultural heritage and aims to position Dubrovnik as a cultural and tourist destination beyond its seasonal appeal while preserving its rich heritage.

Solution 2: Community-Centred Tourism Development

Mexico City, Mexico: *Creative, cultural and community tourism projects by communities and groups*

A collaboration between the Government of Mexico City, UNESCO Mexico, and Airbnb has resulted in the creation of 24 new cultural and community tourism projects to promote responsible tourism. These projects focus on safeguarding

heritage and cultural diversity, providing economic benefits to local communities outside of traditional tourist areas, and addressing the negative impacts of tourism, while also showing the benefits of collaboration between intergovernmental organizations and the private sector. The initiatives were enhanced to include sustainable tourism models and have already involved more than 1,000 participants, both locals and tourists. The programmes, which highlight local culture and history, are featured in a catalogue which can be found on the UNESCO website and available on the Airbnb platform for reservations.

Ljubljana, Slovenia: *Creative Tourism through Crafts*

Ljubljana Tourism, in partnership with the City's Department for Culture, launched a creative tourism project celebrating traditional crafts. Historical records revealed 80 artisan professions, many now extinct or missing from the city centre. After identifying active craftsmen, the team visited workshops, conducted interviews, and analyzed themes to design unique tourism experiences. Five boutique activities were created: printing postcards in a letterpress studio, crafting pottery, weaving handmade pieces, making silver rings, and repairing umbrellas. These experiences connect cultural heritage with interactive tourism, engaging both locals and visitors. The project supports artisans through development, promotion, and marketing, creating new income opportunities and boosting the local economy. With plans to expand offerings, this initiative strengthens Ljubljana's cultural identity and establishes it as a creative tourism destination.

Solution 3: Creative Urban Spaces and Regeneration

Wuhan, China: *East Lake Greenway Phase III — Harmonizing Urban Culture, Ecology, and Function*

East Lake Greenway Phase III, led by the Wuhan Municipal Bureau of Landscape and Forestry, was designed by the Wuhan Planning & Design Institute in collaboration with the Landscape Architecture Corporation of China and built by Wuhan Urban Development Group. With its completion, the entire 105-kilometer loop around East Lake is now finished – creating a culturally rich, eco-friendly public space for all to enjoy. This new phase introduces a thoroughly designed "Literary Path" featuring separate lanes for walking, cycling, and driving, as well as 11 waterside rest areas where visitors can enjoy

lake views. The route connects major cultural and sports landmarks, including Wuhan University, Water Sports Center, and the Institute of Hydrobiology at theChinese Academy of Sciences. At the Institute, a newly renovated bas-relief corridor integrates traditional Chinese motifs with themes from Yangtze River aquatic science. Select institutional courtyards are open to the public, encouraging community engagement. Literary-themed furnishings highlight the area's scholarly heritage. Regular cultural events, such as lakeside concerts and “Jump East Lake” activities, offer immersive experiences for visitors. Since opening, the greenway has helped reduce local temperatures, eased traffic congestion, enhance cultural tourism, and reconnect city residents with nature. During cherry blossom season, the path welcomed up to 300,000 visitors in a single day, solidifying its status as one of Wuhan’s top destinations.

Barcelona, Spain: *Superblock*

The Superblock programme has been developed and consolidated as an international benchmark urban intervention. This initiative aims to make the city of Barcelona more sustainable by reducing vehicle circulation in favour of pedestrians, creating green spaces, promoting sustainable mobility and creating spaces where cultural events, such as concerts or shows, can take place in the neighbourhoods, thanks to strategically located electricity and energy points. Currently, Barcelona counts thirteen Superblocks and plans on expanding the model to an increasing number of spaces. As a city facing increasing tourism flows, Barcelona is using the Superblock initiative to create sustainable and diverse cultural options for locals and visitors.

Dahab, Egypt: *Advancing Sustainable Tourism as a pillar in Strategic Urban Plans for Cities*

A paradigm shift towards “Sustainable Tourism” has gradually emerged in Egypt while being aligned with its national and local policies. This is reflected in the newly updated Strategic Urban Plans for cities, placing sustainable tourism at its centre and offers a broader approach that goes beyond traditional mass tourism. One of these examples is the Strategic Urban Plan for the city of Dahab, developed by the General Organization for Physical Planning which contributes to the regeneration and enrichment of local ecosystems and communities while promoting the city as a sustainable tourism destination.

Solution 4: Sustainable Cultural Economy

Kanazawa, Japan: *Sustainable Tourism Plan*

The plan emphasizes initiatives that focus on sustainable tourism rooted in the city's traditions and culture. It also addresses challenges such as traffic congestion and deteriorating hygiene caused by an under managed tourism growth. The plan outlines strategies to preserve and promote local culture and tradition, while ensuring the well-being of the local community. Action plans include promoting local crafts and food products, collaborating with local travel agencies to develop new travel packages, and developing international sales channels for crafts, among other initiatives. The city also holds regular meetings with the municipal government, travel agencies, private businesses, and local residents to discuss initiatives to build a sustainable city, through tourism.

Tirana, Albania: *The Tirana New Bazaar*

The Tirana New Bazaar, originally built in 1931 to manage trade overflow from the Old Bazaar, has undergone a transformative revitalization. Located in one of Tirana’s oldest areas, once a lively produce market, it is surrounded by 15 cultural heritage buildings. Its recent restoration, led by the Albanian-American Development Foundation (AADF) and the Municipality of Tirana, has turned it into a vibrant pedestrian zone, combining shopping, dining, and nightlife. The initiative exemplifies innovative public-private cooperation aimed at sustainable development and enhancing urban tourism. The project’s focus on preserving heritage while modernizing the space has made it a key attraction, earning recognition as the Best Renewal Project in 2018 by Emerging Europe Awards.

Solution 5: Environmental and Cultural Synergy

Cape Town, South Africa: *Sustainable Cape Town Webpage*

Cape Town Tourism, the city's official destination marketing organization, has developed a website to guide visitors to Cape Town's top sustainable businesses.The site highlights accommodation, restaurants, eco-tours, and local artisan shops that reduce their environmental impact while supporting the local economy and promoting responsible practices.

Solution 6: Cultural Education and Exchange

Bergamo, Italy: *Formative Course for the Enhancement of Products from the Daily Supply Chain*

The 1000-hour course is designed to train up to 25 young professionals under the age of 29 per edition as expert technicians in the valorization of products in the dairy supply chain. Students gain in-depth knowledge of production processes and acquire skills to add value to businesses by ensuring that product preparation meets quality, safety, and authenticity standards. They also look at branding, sharing information history and characteristics of the products, and developing promotional strategies in line with local cultural tourism. This programme provides local dairy businesses with a professionally trained workforce, strengthening the local food industry, maintaining the quality of the city's gastronomy, and boosting the city's attractiveness to tourists.

Solution 7: Digital Cultural Innovation

Dubai, United Arab Emirates: *Digitization of the cultural and creative sectors*

Dubai has become as a global leader in the digitization of its cultural and creative sectors, setting a benchmark for innovation and accessibility. The city has fully digitized its museum experience, providing open access to immersive virtual tours of its museums and heritage sites. In addition, in response to the challenges posed by COVID-19, Dubai launched a wide range of online initiatives that focus on building a sustainable digital ecosystem for its cultural and creative sectors, including virtual museum tours and e-learning courses. These platforms not only ensured continued cultural engagement, but also extended the city's reach, attracting new talent, audiences, and collaborations from around the world.